

THE VOICE BASELINE

The audit that starts with the child and works backwards.

did it reach the child?

Every readiness tool scores the organisation. unbarrier.voice measures the one thing they skip: whether the technology, the access and the communication actually reach the learner they were bought for. Device-agnostic. Built on the learner's own experience. It is the measurement layer under everything unbarrier does.

What a baseline is

Where you are now, scored against the seven questions overleaf. A starting number, not a verdict.

It is a baseline you can measure again later, so "impact" stops being a word and becomes a number you can stand behind.

In the cycle every piece of our work runs on — notice → design → try → embed — voice is what makes notice and embed into measurements rather than impressions. It is the same instrument at both ends, which is the only reason the difference between them means anything.

Where it sits

unbarrier.voice is what unbarrier.audit and unbarrier.access both run on. A discovery day uses it to find the gaps. A partnership year uses it to prove the movement between the start and the end. Same seven questions, every time.

Onboarding: the voice baseline, and the first plan we agree together. The end of the year: the endline against the baseline. After that, renewal on evidence, not goodwill. If the numbers didn't move, that is the conversation we have first.

HOW A BASELINE IS TAKEN

Nici in the room, watching what a survey cannot see.

An Apple Professional Learning Specialist in your classrooms: the workaround a learner has invented, the setting nobody turned on, the moment an adult steps in three seconds too early. Learner data captured alongside it.

Pick any moment in a lesson, and ask all seven questions of it. That is the whole method. It needs no software, and it is the part with the most value in it.

Children are never named — in the room or in the report.

ASKED FROM THE LEARNER'S SIDE

The seven questions

01
Provision

Is there a device, a tool, a connection at all — and is it in the room, charged and working when the lesson starts? *Does the thing exist for this child, or only on the inventory?*

02
Access

Can the child get into it without an adult beside them — the settings, the login, the support features? *Does it work for them, not just work?*

03
Design

Was the material built with more than one way in, before anyone had to ask for an adjustment? *Universal design, and the only lever left where the law cannot reach.*

04
Capability

Can the adults set it up on a Tuesday, and does it hold across teachers, subjects and buildings when the champion is away? *Is this practice, or is it one person?*

05
Belonging

Does the child want to be there, take part without being asked, and get back in when something goes wrong? *Access without belonging is attendance.*

06
Trust

Do the child, the family and the staff believe it will work when it matters — and believe their data is safe? *A tool that fails twice in front of a class is never opened again, whatever the audit says.*

07
Evidence

Can you show a parent, a governor or an inspector what actually changed, without reaching for the word “engagement”? *If it cannot be shown, it cannot be funded, defended, or done again.*

AFTER THE BASELINE

What you get back

01

A one-page picture

Where access is reaching learners, and where it isn't.

02

The gaps, named

In language a governor understands, so the spend can be defended and the next step funded.

03

A number you can measure again

A baseline to return to, so "impact" becomes a number you can stand behind.

04

The check, agreed

We agree how you will know it worked, and when we will check. That movement is your evidence.

TWO PURPOSES, TWO CONSENTS. NEVER BUNDLED.

Your result is yours. The school's own picture, for the school. Separately, and only if you opt in, an anonymised layer builds sector-level insight into what is reaching learners and what isn't, across settings.

These are two different things, so they take two different consents. Bundling them would make neither one valid. That isn't a legal footnote. It is the whole point of an instrument built to be trusted.

IF YOU WANT TO TALK IT THROUGH FIRST

Book 45 minutes with Nici

Tell us what you're working with. If we can help, we'll say how. If we can't, we'll point you to someone who can.

unbarrier.me/book